CSE0001 DIGITAL LITERACY

Project Report

Digital Literacy Portfolio — Student Digital Ambassador

Name	Ajeetesh Kumar
Registration No.	25BCE11023
Branch	B.Tech Computer Science & Engineering (Core)
Year	First Year B.Tech
Course Code	CSE0001
Course Title	Digital Literacy
Institution	VIT Bhopal University
Submission Date	March 2026

Introduction

This report documents my work on the CSE0001 Digital Literacy project. The assignment places us in the role of a Student Digital Ambassador, someone responsible for helping batchmates develop digital skills, build professional profiles, and stay safe online. Working through the five tasks meant actually doing things I had previously just heard about, creating a Canva infographic, setting up a GitHub portfolio, solving a coding challenge, writing professional emails, and researching a cybercrime.

I am a first-year CSE student, so some of this overlapped with things I had started to explore on my own. But there is a difference between casually knowing a platform exists and deliberately sitting down to use it for a specific purpose. That difference showed up in almost every task.

Each task is documented in my GitHub repository, submitted alongside this report. The sections below cover what I made, the tools I used, and what I actually took away from each one.

Project Overview

#	Task	Tools / Deliverable	Marks
01	Digital Literacy Infographic	Canva	20
02	Student Digital Portfolio	GitHub · LinkedIn · Kaggle	20
03	Coding & Collaboration	HackerRank · Google Forms	20
04	Email Etiquette & Social Media	Gmail · MD checklist	20
05	Cybercrime Awareness	Research + Checklist	20

01 Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

What I Made & Which Tool I Used

I used Canva (canva.com) for this task. I had seen Canva mentioned before but never actually opened it, so the first ten minutes were mostly spent figuring out where things were. Once I got past that, it turned out to be genuinely capable for someone with no design background — which is exactly where I am.

The infographic is a single vertical page divided into three sections. The first section defines digital literacy using five components: finding and evaluating information, communicating online, creating content, staying secure, and using digital tools to solve problems. I wrote the descriptions in plain language rather than copying definitions, which forced me to actually understand what each component meant before writing it down.

The second section is a categorised toolkit for students — professional profiles (GitHub, LinkedIn, Kaggle), coding practice (HackerRank, CodeChef), cloud collaboration (Google Drive, Google Forms), and learning resources (NPTEL, Coursera). The third section covers five internet safety practices: strong passwords, two-factor authentication, recognising phishing links, UPI PIN safety, and checking URLs before clicking. Each point gets a short explanation and an icon.

Reflection

The tool used was Canva (canva.com) — a free, browser-based design platform. No installation required. Has hundreds of templates for infographics, presentations, and posters.

What caught me off guard was how long it took to choose a layout. I went through at least a dozen templates before settling on one. Most of them had a style that would feel out of place when shared with batchmates — either too decorative or too corporate. I wanted something clean and readable, something a first-year student would actually look at rather than close immediately.

The harder problem was length. I had written a lot more for each section than would fit on one page. Cutting it down without losing the point took several rounds. The constraint ended up being useful — it made me decide what actually mattered versus what was just padding. The cybercrime section, for instance, got cut from a full paragraph to three bullet points, and honestly the three bullet points communicated more than the paragraph did.

The one detail I had not thought about before: colour contrast. I picked a blue that looked clean in the main sections but became completely unreadable when used as small text on a slightly

different background. That took a few attempts to fix. Small thing, but it made me notice that visual design has technical requirements just like code does.

> **Takeaway:** Design tools like Canva are immediately useful for presentations and project summaries throughout a degree. Starting early, even casually, builds a skill that pays off in ways that are not obvious until you need it.

02 Student Digital Portfolio

Which Platforms I Set Up

I created or refreshed accounts on GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle. The choice of these three came from a simple question: what will actually matter by the time I am looking for internships? The answer pointed clearly to these three.

GitHub (github.com)

Link - https://github.com/ajeeteshKr20

Where developers store and version code, collaborate on projects, and build the kind of public record that comes up when someone Googles your name in a technical context. I created a profile README, the special repository that appears on your profile page, with my name, branch (B.Tech CSE), year, and a short line about what I want to build during my degree. I kept it honest rather than ambitious. A straightforward introduction is better than one that overpromises at this stage.

LinkedIn (linkedin.com)

Link - https://www.linkedin.com/in/ajeetesh-kumar-3070383bb/

The professional networking platform that recruiters, hiring managers, and internship coordinators use constantly. I filled in the Education section: B.Tech Computer Science and Engineering, VIT Bhopal University, expected graduation 2029. No photo, no contact details yet. The brief recommended keeping it minimal at this stage, and that felt right. An empty profile that is honest is better than a padded one.

Kaggle (kaggle.com)

Link - https://www.kaggle.com/ajeeteshkumar

Google's platform for data science and machine learning — free courses, real-world datasets, and competitions. I signed up because I want to go deeper into AI and ML, and Kaggle came up repeatedly in conversations with seniors as a platform where you can demonstrate actual data skills rather than just list them on a resume. I have not done anything meaningful on it yet, but having an account set up and knowing what the platform is for felt like the right foundation.

Reflection

The thing that struck me most about this task was not the act of signing up for platforms — that part takes minutes. It was writing the GitHub README. Even four or five lines about yourself and what you are working towards forces you to think about how you want to be seen in a

professional context, which is not something most first-year students have had to consider before.

I kept it short because I am genuinely at the beginning. I had not built anything yet, contributed to anything yet, or even finished a semester of coursework. Writing something inflated would feel dishonest. But writing something honest, even if it is minimal, already makes the profile better than most first-year profiles I have looked at.

Over the next four years: GitHub gets all my projects, including lab work and personal experiments. LinkedIn gets updated with internships, certifications, and anything actually worth mentioning. Kaggle gets used seriously from the third semester once the ML and data structures coursework gives me the tools to do something real with it. Four years is a long time. Starting now, even with almost nothing on the profiles, means I am not starting from zero in Year 3.

> **Takeaway:** Professional digital presence is not something you prepare right before placements. It builds over four years. The right time to start is now, with minimal content, rather than later with something rushed.

03 Coding & Collaboration Platforms

Part A — HackerRank Coding Challenge

I chose HackerRank from the three options because it came up most often in conversations about placement preparation — specifically, that the coding rounds in most campus placements at VIT use a similar format. Starting to understand that format in first year seemed more useful than starting from scratch in third year.

I started with "Solve Me First," which asks you to write a function that returns the sum of two integers. The problem itself is trivial. The useful part was everything around it: reading input from standard input rather than writing your own prompts, matching the exact output format expected by the test runner, and understanding why your solution can be logically correct and still fail if it prints an extra character. My first submission failed on every test case because I had included a line asking the user to enter a number. That line printed in the output. The test runner compared output character-by-character and found a mismatch. Second submission, without the prompt, passed everything.

I also completed "Say Hello, World! With Python" and got the Python one-star badge. Something I did not expect: seeing the badge actually made me want to do the next one. That is the point of the gamification, and it works.

Part B — Google Form: Digital Literacy Quiz

I built a five-question Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz using Google Forms, titled "Before You Click: A Digital Literacy Quiz for VIT First Years." The form includes three multiple-choice questions, one true/false question, and one short-answer question. It is linked to a Google Sheet that collects responses automatically.

The questions focus on practical scenarios rather than definitions. One asks what the padlock icon in a browser actually guarantees (answer: only that the connection is encrypted, not that the site is trustworthy). Another presents four password options and asks which is the weakest. The short-answer question asks respondents to describe, in their own words, how a phishing link typically reaches someone.

Writing good multiple-choice questions turned out to be harder than I expected. The wrong answers have to be plausible enough that someone who half-understands the concept might choose them. If the wrong answers are obviously wrong, you are testing reading comprehension rather than actual knowledge. I spent more time on the wrong answer options than on the questions themselves.

Reflection

The HackerRank experience taught me something specific about competitive coding that I could not have learned from a textbook: the evaluation environment is not forgiving. Local development tools tell you what went wrong. A competitive judge just tells you you are wrong. Understanding that format early — before it matters — is genuinely useful.

Google Forms surprised me. I went into it expecting a simple form builder. It is actually a complete data collection pipeline. The moment a test response appeared in the linked Sheet in real time, I started thinking about how many different ways this is useful: feedback surveys, quiz grading, event registration, peer reviews. That shift from "tool for assignment" to "tool I will actually use" happened during this task.

> **HackerRank:** Regular practice from second year onward for placement preparation. The format is learnable and the earlier you understand it, the less it intimidates you during actual rounds.
>
> **Google Forms:** Immediately useful for group work, event coordination, and feedback collection. The Sheets integration makes it a full data pipeline without any code.

04 Email Etiquette & Social Media Guide

Part A — The Email Drafts

I wrote two email drafts. The first is from a student to a professor requesting a deadline extension. The second is an expression of interest in a summer internship, addressed to a coordinator at a company.

Writing both made me realise something I had not consciously noticed before: most of the emails I have sent to faculty in the past had no subject line, no greeting, and no sign-off. Just a question dropped into the body of the email as if it were a WhatsApp message. That is not professional communication. It is just text delivery.

The subject line turned out to be the part I spent the most time on. A subject line like "Doubt" tells the recipient nothing before they open the email. A subject line like "Request for Extension — Data Structures Assignment 2 — Sec A1" tells them everything: who you are, what you want, and which course it relates to. If a professor receives fifty emails a day, the subject line is what determines whether yours gets opened now or later.

The internship email was a different challenge. You are writing to someone who did not ask to hear from you, about something you want, from a position where you have very little to offer yet. I was writing about AWS Cloud Services — something I had been studying through NPTEL — and I had to be honest that I am in first year and the knowledge is basic, while still making a clear case for why I was interested and what I had been doing about it. The balance is between not overselling and not underselling. A transparent, specific email is always more credible than one that pads a thin CV with enthusiasm.

Email 1 — Assignment Extension Request

> **Subject:** Request for Deadline Extension
>
> Dear Professor,
>
> I hope you are doing well.
>
> I am writing to request a short extension for the AI ML assignment, which is currently due on 30/03/2026. I am enrolled in your Fundamental and AI ML course this semester (Registration No.: 25BCE11023).

Over the past few days, I have been unwell, which has affected my ability to complete the assignment as planned. I have attached my medical certificate for your reference.

I have already completed around 90% of the work and believe that with a little more time, I can submit it in a much better and more polished form. I would be grateful if you could kindly grant me an extension until 31/03/2026.

I understand that this request is entirely at your discretion, and I sincerely apologize for any inconvenience caused.

Thank you for your time and consideration.

Yours' Sincerely,

Ajeetesh Kumar

25BCE11023

B.Tech Computer Science and Engineering

Email 2 — Internship Interest

Subject: Internship Interest - Summer 2026

Dear Sir,

I hope this email finds you in the best of health and spirits. This is Ajeetesh, a first-year B.Tech student in Computer Science and Engineering at VIT Bhopal University. I got to know about Amazon AWS Cloud Services through your LinkedIn profile and I'm writing this email to express my interest in the summer internship program.

I'm interested in the company because of setting up servers or running applications required a lot of physical infrastructure, but with AWS, everything can be done online within minutes. This idea of accessing computing resources anytime and from anywhere feels very powerful.

I have been learning and working on the Cloud Computing through NPTEL and I'm interested in applying this knowledge in the real world, however basic it might be.

Though I'm in the first year of my course, I'm interested in learning and contributing to the best of my knowledge and skills. I have attached my resume for your reference.

> Thanks for your time in reading this mail.
>
> Sincerely,
> Ajeetesh Kumar
> 25BCE11023
> B.Tech Computer Science and Engineering
> https://www.linkedin.com/in/ajeetesh-kumar-3070383bb/

Part B — Social Media Checklist

The full checklist is saved as social-media-checklist.md in the task-4-email-etiquette/ folder. A summary is below.

Do's

- Think before posting. Ask yourself: would this be a problem if a recruiter or professor saw it?
- Keep LinkedIn and GitHub updated. Even small updates — a completed course, a new repository — signal activity.
- Set personal accounts (Instagram, Snapchat) to private. Review privacy settings each semester.
- Credit others when you share their work, articles, or code.
- Respond to professional messages within 48 hours, even if just to acknowledge receipt.
- Use two-factor authentication on every account that offers it.

Don'ts

- Don't post in anger or frustration. Draft it, wait, then decide whether to send.
- Don't share your real-time location — checking in at a hostel or library creates an unnecessary safety risk.
- Don't reuse passwords across accounts. If one is compromised, all of them are.
- Don't accept connection requests from people you cannot identify, even on LinkedIn.
- Don't photograph or post about classmates without their permission.
- Don't vent publicly about faculty, administration, or the institution.

Reflection

There is a specific scenario I keep thinking about. A student in their third year, mid-placement season, gets through three interview rounds at a company they really want. During the background check stage, the recruiter searches their name. The first result is a thread from two

years ago where the student is arguing aggressively with strangers in a comment section about something that, in hindsight, does not matter at all. The offer does not come through.

The posts were probably written in two minutes and forgotten in five. The student was not doing anything wrong by their own standards at the time. But those posts were public, indexed, and still there two years later when it mattered. What could have been done differently? Reviewing and cleaning up past posts before starting the application process — less than an hour of work.

> **Key takeaway:** Treat your public social media activity the way you would treat a formal document. You are accountable for it, and it represents you long after you have moved on from it.

05 Cybercrime Awareness Case Study

The Case Study — UPI Fraud

I chose UPI fraud because it is the cybercrime most likely to affect a college student in India right now. Every student uses PhonePe, Google Pay, or Paytm daily. The gap between using these apps constantly and actually understanding how they work is exactly where this fraud operates.

The case study covers the Collect Request scam. Here is how it works in a typical scenario: a student posts in a college buy-sell group looking for second-hand textbooks. A contact they do not recognise messages them privately, offering to sell notes cheaply. The seller says payment must come first and sends a QR code. The QR code is not a payment code. It is a Collect Request, which when scanned and confirmed, authorises a debit from the victim's account.

The victim enters their UPI PIN thinking they are paying a small amount. They are actually approving a much larger debit. The transaction completes in seconds. The fraudster immediately blocks them on all platforms.

The reason this scam is so effective is specific and worth understanding. The UPI interface does not clearly distinguish between initiating a payment and approving a collect request at the confirmation screen. Both screens ask for your PIN. Both look essentially the same. The only difference is who gets the money. A user who has not been specifically told to look for this distinction will not see it.

Prevention Checklist

My checklist has ten points across four categories: account security, UPI and payment safety, phishing and link safety, and identity protection. The final entry in the checklist is the National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal at cybercrime.gov.in and the 24-hour helpline 1930.

#	Safety Tip
1	Never share your UPI PIN or OTP with anyone. No bank, no helpline, no support agent will ever ask for it.
2	Receiving money never requires scanning a QR code or entering your PIN. If someone says otherwise, it is a scam. (UPI-specific)
3	Always check the registered name shown by your UPI app after entering the recipient's ID — before entering your PIN. (UPI-specific)
4	Set a daily UPI transaction limit in your banking app. Even ₹5,000 caps your maximum loss in a single fraudulent transaction.

5	Enable biometric lock on UPI apps so a stolen or borrowed phone cannot be used to make payments.
6	Do not click links in SMS, WhatsApp, or emails claiming to be from your bank. Go to the official app or website directly.
7	Check URLs carefully before entering any credentials. A single transposed letter (e.g. sbi-bank.com instead of sbi.co.in) is a phishing site.
8	Enable login notifications on all financial and email accounts so unauthorised access shows up immediately.
9	Never post photos of your Aadhaar, student ID, or any official document publicly. These are used for identity theft.
10	Report immediately at cybercrime.gov.in or call 1930 (24×7). For UPI fraud, early reporting gives banks a window to attempt reversal.

Report online: cybercrime.gov.in

Helpline: 1930 (24 × 7, available across India)

For UPI fraud: report within the first few hours. Banks can sometimes reverse a transaction if notified before the funds settle.

Reflection

What surprised me most was how technically simple the most effective UPI scams are. There is no hacking. No code. No sophisticated software. The only thing the fraudster needs is for the victim to misunderstand one UI element at one specific moment. The entire attack is built on a single piece of confusion about how two nearly identical screens work differently.

I had assumed, before this task, that people who fall for these scams were generally older or less comfortable with smartphones. That assumption is wrong. The scam does not require unfamiliarity with technology. It requires unfamiliarity with a specific workflow, which is a different thing entirely. A student who uses UPI ten times a day can still fall for a Collect Request scam because they have simply never had a reason to learn what that specific screen means.

The habit I am changing: before I confirm any UPI transaction I did not myself initiate, I now ask one question — am I sending money or receiving it? If the answer is not obvious from the screen, I cancel and verify through a different channel. Three seconds of checking is worth considerably more than the recovery process for a fraudulent transaction that completed in five.

Personal habit change: Before entering a UPI PIN for any transaction initiated by someone else, I ask one question: am I sending money or receiving it? If I cannot answer with certainty from the screen, I cancel.

Conclusion

This project covered a lot of ground in a short time. Some tasks overlapped with things I had started exploring on my own as a CSE student. Others were entirely new. The email etiquette task was the one I least expected to learn from — and then actually sat down to write a proper professional email for the first time and realised I did not really know what I was doing.

The cybercrime task ended up being the most interesting. I went into it expecting to document something I already knew about broadly. What I did not expect was to actually understand, mechanically, why a specific scam works — not just that it exists. Understanding something at that level of detail is very different from knowing it exists, and it changes how you behave.

The GitHub repository as a submission format is something I think is well-designed. At the end of this course I do not just have a grade. I have a repository with some structure, some content, and some commits. That is a more useful outcome than a printed PDF that gets filed away. Starting four years of a B.Tech with a GitHub repository that has something in it — even if that something is modest — is better than starting with nothing.

References

- Canva — canva.com (infographic design tool)
- GitHub — github.com (code portfolio and version control)
- LinkedIn — linkedin.com (professional networking platform)
- Kaggle — kaggle.com (data science and ML platform)
- HackerRank — hackerrank.com (coding practice and placement preparation)
- Google Forms / Google Sheets — forms.google.com
- National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal — cybercrime.gov.in
- Reserve Bank of India — UPI Safety Consumer Advisories, rbi.org.in
- VITyarthi Portal — CSE0001 Project Brief and Course Material, VIT Bhopal University